

ACM — Authority Continuity Module

Parent Standard: Operational Authority Integrity Standard (OAIS)

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Authority Continuity

Type: Operational Authority Integrity Module

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Compatibility: OOF Methodology OS · Operational Authority Integrity Standard (OAIS) · Operational Decision Integrity Standard (ODIS) · Runtime Integrity Standard (RIS) · Authority & Accountability Layer Standard (AALS) · Operational Evidence & Auditability Standard (OEAS) · INTEGROS® — Integrity Standard · Autonomous Runtime Systems · Multi- Agent Infrastructures

Authority: OOF

Protection: MIP — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Authority Continuity Module (ACM) defines the structural conditions under which runtime authority continuity, delegated authority persistence, distributed authority coordination, and consequence-bearing authority flow remain materially stable, traceable, and operationally governable across runtime operational environments.

A system satisfies ACM only if:

- runtime authority continuity remains materially stable
- delegated authority persistence preserves operational legitimacy
- distributed authority coordination remains coherent
- consequence-bearing authority flow remains traceable
- authority fragmentation does not destabilize operational continuity

A system that preserves runtime execution while authority continuity materially fragments does not satisfy ACM.

Module Operational Role

ACM defines the authority continuity layer of OAIS by preserving stable runtime authority continuity across operational environments.

Module Operational Space

ACM governs the authority continuity space of OAIS by preserving delegated authority persistence, distributed authority coherence, escalation continuity, and consequence-bearing authority stability across runtime systems.

Module Function

The module applies wherever systems must preserve:

- runtime authority continuity
- delegated authority persistence
- distributed authority coordination
- escalation authority continuity
- consequence-bearing authority flow
- governance-valid operational legitimacy

Its function is to ensure that runtime operational authority remains materially continuous strongly enough to preserve governance-valid operational legitimacy across execution environments.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Authority Continuity Object

The organization must define which operational authority structures require continuity governance.

This may include:

- delegated runtime authority
 - orchestration authority routing
 - escalation authority pathways
 - distributed operational hierarchies
 - autonomous runtime delegation
 - consequence-bearing authority flows
 - operational-critical authority chains
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2. Define Authority Continuity Conditions

The system must define the conditions under which operational authority continuity remains materially stable and operationally aligned.

This includes:

- delegated authority persistence
 - distributed authority coherence
 - escalation continuity
 - operational legitimacy continuity
 - governance-valid authority traceability
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3. Define Authority Fragmentation Detection Logic

The system must define how materially unstable authority continuity or authority fragmentation is identified.

This may include:

- delegation discontinuity
 - escalation instability
 - distributed authority divergence
 - authority-traceability degradation
 - consequence-bearing authority fragmentation
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4. Define Operational Response or Governance Logic

The system must define governance logic for materially unstable authority continuity conditions.

Governance response may include:

- authority synchronization
 - delegation stabilization
 - escalation review activation
 - authority reconstruction
 - distributed coordination correction
 - operational invalidation where required
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5. Preserve Traceability & Restrict Invalid Conditions

The system must preserve reconstructable traceability of authority continuity and authority-fragmentation states. A system must not remain authority-valid if runtime operational authority materially fragments while systems continue assuming governance-valid legitimacy remains preserved.

Use Case 1 — Distributed AI Authority

Infrastructure

Scenario

A distributed AI infrastructure continuously routes delegated operational authority across autonomous runtime agents and orchestration systems.

Application

ACM preserves governance-valid authority continuity through distributed delegation governance and escalation continuity stabilization.

Result

The organization gains stronger operational legitimacy and reduced hidden authority fragmentation across distributed AI systems.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Enterprise Runtime

Environment

Scenario

An autonomous enterprise environment continuously coordinates delegated operational authority across distributed execution systems and adaptive operational infrastructures.

Application

ACM preserves governance-valid authority persistence through runtime authority synchronization and distributed coordination governance.

Result

The environment gains stronger authority continuity and reduced operational legitimacy instability across autonomous operational systems.

Canonical Closing Statement

If runtime operational authority cannot remain materially continuous across operational environments, systems may preserve execution continuity while governance-valid legitimacy progressively fragments across runtime coordination layers.

Related Documents

→ [Operational Authority Integrity Standard - \(OAIS\)](#).

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